

Upper Yangtze Forests

A landscape of evergreen and deciduous forests between the Yangtze and Yellow rivers, home to China's iconic giant panda



The forests of the Upper Yangtze extend eastward from the Hengduan Mountains and across the provinces of Sichuan and Shaanxi in south-central China. Covering an area of 150,600 square miles (390,000 square km), this ecoregion comprises three subregions: the evergreen broadleaf forests of the Sichuan Basin, the Daba Mountains evergreen forests, and the deciduous forests of Qinling.

The forests in the north of the region are made up of deciduous and mixed conifer species that thrive in the area's cooler, more temperate climate. The forests of the lower-lying Qinling Mountains support a dense bamboo understory, providing food and shelter for species such as the rare giant panda. In the warmer Sichuan Basin, subtropical evergreen broadleaf trees flourish, and it is here that the dawn redwood, a deciduous conifer previously known only from fossil remains, was discovered growing in the 1940s.

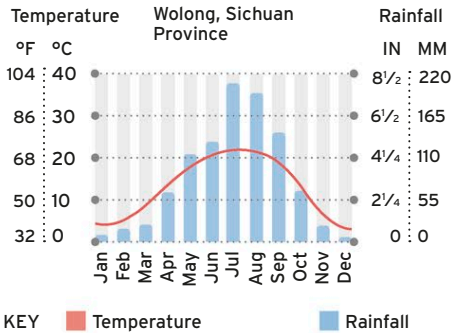
▽ AUTUMN LEAVES

In autumn, the oak, walnut, and maple trees of the Qinling Mountain foothills create a colorful patchwork landscape. The area is also home to the primitive ginkgo, whose leaves turn golden in autumn.



CLIMATE

Due to its higher altitude, the climate in the Upper Yangtze is generally temperate, with mild winters, but temperatures in the lower-lying Sichuan Basin can reach 84°F (29°C). Humidity in the entire region is generally high.



▽ BAMBOO DIET

Once common in lowland areas, the giant panda has moved to the mountains due to human expansion. As bamboo makes up 99 percent of its diet, it can only live where bamboo forests thrive.

Together, the Upper Yangtze forests contain **one-fifth** of all **China's mammal species**

